



1. Dehydration is underestimated as a performance diminisher.

- Let's start on a positive note. Water's free in so many ways. Calorie free, caffeine free, free to consume when from the tap and we're blessed that it is readily available to us.

- Despite this, many people have a coffee in the morning and then no other liquid until lunch time.

Waiting until you feel thirsty is a bad approach because at this point performance is already impaired.

2. How much should I drink?

- Peak performance specialist Ron Friedman recommends $\frac{1}{2}$ ounce to an ounce of water for every pound you weigh.
- Let's take a 75kg female and convert that to pounds which is 165. Then, dividing by two we get 82.5 ounces of water which converts to 2.44 litres to Europeanise the example. :-)
- You may need to consume more on a day when you are exercising more or the weather is warmer than usual.

3. The urine rule – another hydration level indicator.

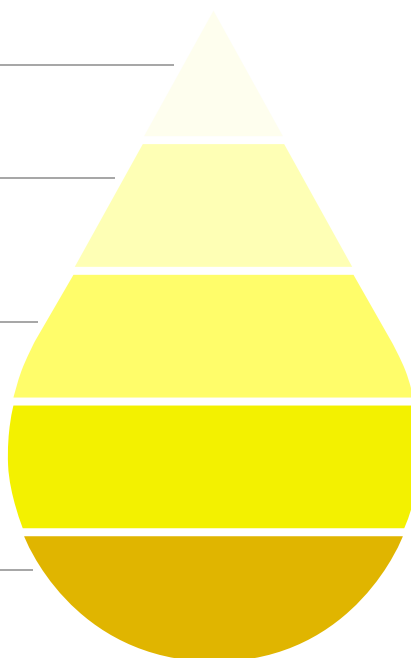
You're topped up with fluids.
Keep it up!

You're almost there
but you could still drink a little more to get everything in balance.

You're moderately dehydrated.
so drink more fluids.

You're very dehydrated.
Drink some fluids to get back on track.

You're seriously dehydrated.
Drink some water or other fluids without delay.





4. Do tea and coffee count towards hydration?

- A regular cup of tea will have a net hydrating effect due to the favourable ratio of water to caffeine. It should not be relied upon for hydration.
- A shot of espresso does not have such a favourable ratio and thus would not be hydrating.
- It appears caffeinated drinks might have a small diuretic effect which means they may cause the need to urinate more often. Despite this they don't appear to increase the risk of dehydration unless we use them as a water replacement instead of as a supplement to our fluid intake.

5. The best way to flavour water.

- In my opinion, the best way to flavour water is with fresh mint and cucumber – it is amazingly refreshing. Some people don't particularly like the neutral flavour of water so this livens it up a bit.
- Using dilute orange is not a good solution on account of the sheer amount of sugar in it. This is a health diminishing habit that is well worth kicking and can be a relatively easy win.

6. Health seeking habit with a dual benefit.

- Always have a bottle on your desk to remind you to drink water. The knock-on benefit is that it is a good excuse to leave the desk for 2-3 minutes every hour and up the step count at the same time.

7. Other helpful hints.

- Your body wants hydration first thing in the day and nothing else. Dedicate that first hour to getting a couple of glasses in to cleanse your system and begin the hydration process.
- If you're sensitive to caffeine, then a good rule of thumb is no caffeinated beverages after 14.00. $\frac{1}{2}$ of the caffeine will still be in your system 5-6 hours after consumption which is the reason many of us find that it can have a disruptive impact on our sleep.

